which is along the axis of the solenoid, the integrals

$$\int_b^c \vec{B}.d\vec{l} = \int_b^c \left|\vec{B}\right|\left|d\vec{l}\right| \cos 90^\circ = 0$$

Similarly

$$\int_d^a \vec{B}.d\vec{l} = 0$$

Since the magnetic field outside the solenoid is zero, the integral $\int_c^d \vec{B}.d\vec{l} = 0$

For the path along ab, the integral is

$$\int_a^b \vec{B}.d\vec{l} = B\int_a^b dl \cos 0^\circ = B\int_a^b dl$$

where the length of the loop ab as shown in the Figure 3.41 is h. But the choice of length of the loop ab is arbitrary. We can take very large loop such that it is equal to the length of the solenoid L. Therefore the integral is

$$\int_a^b \vec{B}.d\vec{l} = BL$$

Let I be the current passing through the solenoid of N turns, then

$$\int_a^b \vec{B}.d\vec{l} = BL = \mu_\circ NI \Rightarrow B = \mu_\circ \frac{NI}{L}$$

The number of turns per unit length is given by $\frac{N}{L} = n$, Then

$$B = \mu_\circ \frac{nLI}{L} = \mu_\circ nI \qquad (3.52)$$

Since n is a constant for a given solenoid and μ_0 is also constant. For a fixed current I, the magnetic field inside the solenoid is also a constant.

Note

Solenoid can be used as electromagnet. It produces strong magnetic field that can be turned ON or OFF. This is not possible in case of permanent magnet. Further the strength of the magnetic field can be increased by keeping iron bar inside the solenoid. This is because the magnetic field of the solenoid magnetizes the iron bar and hence the net magnetic field is the sum of magnetic field of the solenoid and magnetic field of magnetised iron. Because of these properties, solenoids are useful in designing variety of electrical appliances.

EXAMPLE 3.16

Calculate the magnetic field inside a solenoid, when

(a) the length of the solenoid becomes twice with fixed number of turns

(b) both the length of the solenoid and number of turns are doubled

(c) the number of turns becomes twice for the fixed length of the solenoid

Compare the results.

Solution

The magnetic field of a solenoid (inside) is

$$B_{L,N} = \mu_\circ \frac{NI}{L}$$

(a) length of the solenoid becomes twice with fixed number of turns

$L \rightarrow 2L$ (length becomes twice)

$N \rightarrow N$ (number of turns remains constant)

The magnetic field is

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